SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

1 June 2022 · Shift 2

79 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 21 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 21 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Zeal; burning enthusiasm; passion

(A) Arid
(B) Ardour
(C) Arcuate
(D) Arena

Q.2

Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. A.It is unquestionably evident that this virus brought misery and grief into the lives of the people of other professions too. B.Covid-19 changed the form and face of every field in the world. It did not leave any field untouched. C.One of the most affected areas is education. Millions of students all over the world could not get a proper education. D.Millions of the teachers who are working, specifically in private educational institutes, were not paid full salary during the pandemic.

(A) ACDB
(B) BCDA
(C) DABC
(D) CBDA

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Vishnu and family “are looking around into” the possibility of moving to Canada.

(A) are looking upto
(B) look into
(C) are looking into
(D) are looking around to

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Hit the books

(A) To have a very long list
(B) To feel sorry about a mistake
(C) Become very confused
(D) To study very hard

Q.5

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Devastate

(A) Destroy
(B) Produce
(C) Recite
(D) Suppress

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We would have loved to stay _____ like children all our lives.

(A) innocent
(B) shy
(C) fragile
(D) cunning

Q.7

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. I remember vivid / the last road trip / we had / before the pandemic hit.

(A) the last road trip
(B) we had
(C) before the pandemic hit
(D) I remember vivid

Q.8

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The manager / did not / gone to / Bombay yesterday.

(A) gone to
(B) did not
(C) Bombay yesterday
(D) The manager

Q.9

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Squalid

(A) Contemporary
(B) Bare
(C) Advanced
(D) Clean

Q.10

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Vanity

(A) Beauty
(B) Empty
(C) Humility
(D) Conceit

Q.11

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. Diwali sweets were being prepared by our grandmother.

(A) Our grandmother prepared Diwali sweets.
(B) Our grandmother was preparing Diwali sweets.
(C) Our grandmother is preparing Diwali sweets.
(D) Our grandmother prepares Diwali sweets.

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. This cat and mouse game “are” famous with all children in the future.

(A) would have been
(B) is
(C) will be
(D) was

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act 2005 (Mahatma Gandhi NREGA) aims at enhancing _____ security of households in rural areas of the country by providing at least one hundred days of guaranteed wage employment in a financial year to every household whose adult members volunteer to do unskilled manual work.

(A) balanced
(B) total
(C) strict
(D) livelihood

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A piece of cake

(A) An ambitious person
(B) An easy task
(C) An obstacle
(D) A punishment

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Profess

(A) Convince
(B) Assume
(C) Predict
(D) Declare

Q.16

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Glamour
(B) Quarantine
(C) Guarantee
(D) Queeuee

Q.20

Select the sentence which has no spelling error.

(A) Playing and eating are the two prime works during vecation.
(B) Ooty is my dream vacashun spot.
(C) Geeta is going to Pune for vakation.
(D) Children welcome summer vacation with zeal.

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Claims have been made that vaccines are responsible for certain (1)_____ health conditions, particularly autism, speech disorders and inflammatory bowel disease. Some of those claims focused on thimerosal, a mercury-containing compound used as a preservative in vaccines. Some people believed that autism (2)_____ a form of mercury poisoning, caused specifically by thimerosal in childhood vaccines. Those claims have been discredited. Still, misinformation and fear generated by false claims about associations (3)_____ autism and vaccines had a significant impact on individuals' perceptions about vaccine safety. (4)_____, most individuals in countries where vaccination is widespread have never personally experienced vaccine-preventable disease. Thus, the focus of concern for some people shifted from the negative effects of vaccine-preventable disease to the possible negative effects of the vaccines (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) contemptuous
(B) adverse
(C) affirm
(D) disperse

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Claims have been made that vaccines are responsible for certain (1)_____ health conditions, particularly autism, speech disorders and inflammatory bowel disease. Some of those claims focused on thimerosal, a mercury-containing compound used as a preservative in vaccines. Some people believed that autism (2)_____ a form of mercury poisoning, caused specifically by thimerosal in childhood vaccines. Those claims have been discredited. Still, misinformation and fear generated by false claims about associations (3)_____ autism and vaccines had a significant impact on individuals' perceptions about vaccine safety. (4)_____, most individuals in countries where vaccination is widespread have never personally experienced vaccine-preventable disease. Thus, the focus of concern for some people shifted from the negative effects of vaccine-preventable disease to the possible negative effects of the vaccines (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2

(A) will
(B) shall
(C) was
(D) were

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Claims have been made that vaccines are responsible for certain (1)_____ health conditions, particularly autism, speech disorders and inflammatory bowel disease. Some of those claims focused on thimerosal, a mercury-containing compound used as a preservative in vaccines. Some people believed that autism (2)_____ a form of mercury poisoning, caused specifically by thimerosal in childhood vaccines. Those claims have been discredited. Still, misinformation and fear generated by false claims about associations (3)_____ autism and vaccines had a significant impact on individuals' perceptions about vaccine safety. (4)_____, most individuals in countries where vaccination is widespread have never personally experienced vaccine-preventable disease. Thus, the focus of concern for some people shifted from the negative effects of vaccine-preventable disease to the possible negative effects of the vaccines (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) one another
(B) between
(C) each other
(D) through

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Claims have been made that vaccines are responsible for certain (1)_____ health conditions, particularly autism, speech disorders and inflammatory bowel disease. Some of those claims focused on thimerosal, a mercury-containing compound used as a preservative in vaccines. Some people believed that autism (2)_____ a form of mercury poisoning, caused specifically by thimerosal in childhood vaccines. Those claims have been discredited. Still, misinformation and fear generated by false claims about associations (3)_____ autism and vaccines had a significant impact on individuals' perceptions about vaccine safety. (4)_____, most individuals in countries where vaccination is widespread have never personally experienced vaccine-preventable disease. Thus, the focus of concern for some people shifted from the negative effects of vaccine-preventable disease to the possible negative effects of the vaccines (5)_____.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) themselves
(B) yourself
(C) ourselves
(D) itself

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and fourth term is related to third term. POINT : TPKQP :: BONES : SPPHB :: SEVEN : ?

(A) MEXHS
(B) NEXHS
(C) MFXHS
(D) NFXHS

Q.2

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 11,33,38,266,275,?

(A) 3030
(B) 3035
(C) 3025
(D) 3020

Q.3

In a certain code language, 'FLUTE' is written as 'VGFOU' and 'EXILE' is written as 'VORCV'. How will 'BLOOD' be written in that language?

(A) WLLDB
(B) WLLOY
(C) WLOYD
(D) WLLOB

Q.4

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation.
115 * 25 * 15 * 2 * 3

(A) –, +, =, ×
(B) –, =, ×, ×
(C) =, +, +, ×
(D) =, ×, ×, ×

Q.5

Each of the seven friends, Kirti, Siya, Amita, Preeti, Deepika, Jeet and Pari, has scored different marks in an exam. Pari has scored more than Kirti but less than Siya. Deepika has scored less than Preeti but more than Amita. Kirti has scored more than Preeti. Siya is not the highest scorer. Who among the following has scored more than Pari?

(A) Jeet
(B) Deepika
(C) Amita
(D) Preeti

Q.6

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row:16, 12, 48; Second row: 9, 8, 24; Third row:4,24 ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 48
(B) 46
(C) 50
(D) 44

Q.7

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row- 14, 4, 31; Second row- 38, 10, 79; Third row- 30, 8, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) 78
(B) 73
(C) 63
(D) 68

Q.8

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation.
54*14*5*72*18*31*11

(A) =,×,–,÷,×,+
(B) +,–,=,×,–,×
(C) =, ×,+,÷,–,+
(D) –,+,=,×,÷,–

Q.9

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (15, 5, 150); (7, 5, 14) (NOTE : Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) (16, 8, 128)
(B) (12, 6, 40)
(C) (11, 8, 37)
(D) (14, 7, 108)

Q.10

Three statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: All shoes are boots. All boots are heels. Some slippers are shoes. Conclusions: I. All shoes are heels. II. No slipper is a boot. III. All shoes are slippers.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Only conclusion II follows
(C) Only conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusions I and III follow

Q.11

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 11, 22, 19, ?, 71, 426

(A) 76
(B) 80
(C) 82
(D) 77

Q.12

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, EXCEPT one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 93 - 310
(B) 54 - 180
(C) 48 - 165
(D) 33 - 110

Q.15

Which of the following letter-clusters will replace the question mark (?) in the given series to make it logically complete? WVU, RQP, MLK, HGF, ?

(A) CBA
(B) DCB
(C) BAZ
(D) DCA

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'RISE' is written as ‘QSHJRTDF’ and ‘FALL’ is written as ‘EGZBKMKM’. How will 'KING' be written in that language?

(A) JOHJMOFH
(B) JLHJMORD
(C) OLHJMOFH
(D) JLHJMOFH

Q.18

Which letter-cluster will replace the question mark (?) to complete the given series? XHFM, TEDL, PBBK, ?, HVXI

(A) MYYK
(B) LYZJ
(C) MZXK
(D) NZYJ

Q.20

If 19 September 1999 was Sunday, then what was the day of the week on 19 January 2001?

(A) Friday
(B) Thursday
(C) Saturday
(D) Sunday

Q.22

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs and to balance the given equation. 16*8*10*2*4*28

(A) ×, ÷,−,+, =
(B) ÷,×,+,−, =
(C) −,+,÷,×,=
(D) ÷,×,−,+, =

Q.24

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Ancestors 2.Analyze 3.Antibiotic 4.Analogies 5.Android

(A) 4,2,1,5,3
(B) 4,2,1,3,5
(C) 4,1,2,5,3
(D) 4,1,2,3,5

Q.25

Which two numbers, from amongst the given options, should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? $(2)^3 \div 4 + (72 \div 6) \times 9 - (21 \times 3) + (15 \times 7) = 92$

(A) 6 and 3
(B) 3 and 7
(C) 3 and 9
(D) 6 and 9

Quantitative Aptitude 15 questions

Q.1

A bought a toy at a discount of 35%. If he paid ₹975, then find the marked price of the toy.

(A) ₹1,550
(B) ₹1,650
(C) ₹1,600
(D) ₹1,500

Q.2

Calculate the 3rd proportional to 14 and 28.

(A) 65
(B) 16
(C) 24
(D) 56

Q.4

The marked price of 42 items was equal to the cost price of 70 items. The selling price of 25 items was equal to the marked price of 21 items. Calculate the percentage profit or loss from the sale of each item.

(A) 42% profit
(B) 29% profit
(C) 29% loss
(D) 40% profit

Q.7

The average weight of 8 men is increased by 2 kg when one of them, whose weight is 90 kg, is replaced by another man. What is the weight of the new man?

(A) 74 kg
(B) 116 kg
(C) 92 kg
(D) 106 kg

Q.8

The population of a city increases by 10% annually. If its present population is 21,000, what will be the population in 3 years?

(A) 27951
(B) 27981
(C) 27971
(D) 27961

Q.9

A motorcycle covers 50 km at a speed of 25 km/h. Find the speed of the motorcycle for the next 50 km of the journey so that the average speed of the whole journey will be 30 km/h.

(A) 32.5 km/h
(B) 37.5 km/h
(C) 40 km/h
(D) 35 km/h

Q.10

Which of the following numbers is divisible by 15?

(A) 1,65,485
(B) 3,06,045
(C) 2,12,695
(D) 2,95,145

Q.11

Among the following options, which are NOT sides of a triangle?

(A) 12 cm, 9 cm and 15 cm
(B) 20 cm, 20 cm and 20 cm
(C) 3 cm, 5 cm and 4 cm
(D) 3 cm, 5 cm and 1 cm

Q.17

Find the volume of the cuboid, if its length is twice more than its breadth and its breadth is 8 cm, which is twice its height.

(A) 768 cm^3
(B) 769 cm^3
(C) 767 cm^3
(D) 766 cm^3

Q.19

Under a sale offer for an item, Mahesh was offered 24% discount on the part of the marked price that was paid in cash, but was charged 1.5% on the part of the marked price paid through a credit card. If Mahesh paid 40% of the marked price in cash and the rest through a credit card and his total final payment was ₹6,391, what was the marked price of the item?

(A) ₹7,200
(B) ₹6,900
(C) ₹7,050
(D) ₹7,000

Q.20

Ali and Badal start from the same position and at the same time in a 1200 m circular race, with speeds of 27 km/h and 45 km/h, respectively. Find after how much time they will meet again on the track for the first time when they are both running in the same direction.

(A) 280 seconds
(B) 240 seconds
(C) 250 seconds
(D) 220 seconds

Q.21

A man spends 15% of his income on house rent, 60% of the rest on household expenses and saves the rest. If he saves ₹52,500, what is his total income (in ₹, rounded off to the nearest tens)?

(A) 154410
(B) 145400
(C) 154540
(D) 154420

Q.22

Find the volume of a cuboid 16 m long, 12 m broad and 6 m high.

(A) 1172 m^3
(B) 1572 m^3
(C) 1100 m^3
(D) 1152 m^3

Q.23

The area of a triangle whose perimeter is 36 cm and length of two sides is 17 cm and 9 cm will be:

(A) 32 cm^2
(B) 33 cm^2
(C) 36 cm^2
(D) 35 cm^2

Q.25

Madhuri spends 80% of her salary and Sushma spends 95% of her salary. But the savings of both are equal. Find the income of Sushma, if the sum of their incomes is ₹10,000.

(A) ₹9,000
(B) ₹8,000
(C) ₹4,000
(D) ₹5,000

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1
Thetakudi Harihara Vinayakram, an Indian percussionist, is known for popularising which of the following musical instruments?

(A) Tabla
(B) Sarangi
(C) Ghatam
(D) Sitar

Q.2
What is the name of Pt. Ravi Shankar's autobiography?

(A) Music is Life
(B) My Life, My Music
(C) Music is My Life
(D) Musical Journey

Q.4
The Chairman of the Legislative Council is:

(A) elected by the Chief Minister and their Cabinet
(B) appointed by the Chief Minister of that state
(C) elected by the members of the Legislative Council
(D) appointed by the Governor of that state

Q.5
Sheik Chinna Moulana used to play which of the following instruments?

(A) Mridangam
(B) Ghatam
(C) Tabla
(D) Nadhaswaram

Q.6
'Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar' is given by which of the following bodies?

(A) National School of Drama
(B) Bhartiya Vidya Bhavan
(C) Gandharva Mahavidyalaya
(D) Sangeet Natak Akademi

Q.7
What is a way in which adaptation does NOT take place?

(A) Physiological
(B) Emotional
(C) Behavioural
(D) Morphological

Q.8
Ricky Kej a globally acclaimed musician from India won the 57th Grammy Award for which of the following contributions?

(A) Divine Tides
(B) Winds of Samsara
(C) Mountain Dreams
(D) Mystic Mountains

Q.9
In 1817, which law of periodicity showed that the atomic weight of phosphorus is the mean of those of nitrogen and arsenic?

(A) Moseley's Periodic Law
(B) Mendeleev's Periodic Law
(C) Dobereiner's Law of Triads
(D) Newlands' Octaves Law

Q.10
Which of the following countries won the highest gold medals in Tokyo Olympics 2020?

(A) Japan
(B) Australia
(C) China
(D) United States of America

Q.11
In 1820, who found that electric current causes a nearby magnetic needle to move and thus discovered electromagnetism?

(A) Benjamin Franklin
(B) James Clerk Maxwell
(C) Hans Christian Oersted
(D) Andre-Marie Ampere

Q.12
Which of the following instruments is played by Anokhelal Mishra?

(A) Surbahar
(B) Sarod
(C) Shehnai
(D) Tabla

Q.13
Which of the following is a tributary of Damodar river?

(A) Kangsabati
(B) Shilabati
(C) Rupnarayan
(D) Barakar

Q.14
Which 19-year-old wrestler became the first Indian wrestler to win a silver medal at World Wrestling Championship in October 2021 in the 57 kg weight category?

(A) Bhateri
(B) Anshu Malik
(C) Bipasha
(D) Sanju Devi

Q.15
Shanta and VP Dhananjayan were awarded the Rashtriya Kalidas Samman for 2020-21 for significant contribution to which of the following dance forms?

(A) Bharatanatyam
(B) Odissi
(C) Kathakali
(D) Kuchipudi

Q.16
Which of the following has been designated as the self-regulatory origination for Micro finance institutions in India?

(A) Jan-Dhan
(B) Sab-Dhan
(C) Dhan
(D) Sa-Dhan

Q.17
Manjamma Jogati became India's first transgender folk dancer to receive a Padma Shri honour for her contribution to art in the year ____.

(A) 2012
(B) 2021
(C) 2009
(D) 2018

Q.18
Who gives the Bharat Muni Samman?

(A) Nalanda Dance Research Centre
(B) Government of India
(C) Sangeet Natak Akademi
(D) State Government

Q.19
In which sport is free throw used?

(A) Volleyball
(B) Softball
(C) Basketball
(D) Throw ball

Q.20

The lifting of an object up and down, the parade of an army and the free fall of a heavy object are all examples of which motion?

(A) Rectilinear motion
(B) Periodic motion
(C) Rotational motion
(D) Oscillatory motion

Q.21

Who is the author of the book 'All From Memory: An Autobiography'?

(A) Leila Seth
(B) BV Acharya
(C) Margaret Alva
(D) Sita Ram Goel

Q.22

In February 2022, which state launched the 'Paray Shikshalaya' scheme under which elementary education and mid-day meals for students from class 1 to 7 will be provided in open air classrooms?

(A) Tripura
(B) Assam
(C) West Bengal
(D) Odisha

Q.23

Who among the following is the author of the book 'The Coward And The Sword'?

(A) Rushad Rana
(B) Jimmy Shergill
(C) Uday Chopra
(D) Jugal Hansraj

Q.24

According to the Henry Cavendish experiment conducted in 1797-1798, what was the value of the universal constant of gravity?

(A) 7.75×10^{-13} N m^2 /kg^2
(B) 5.75×10^{-10} N m^2/kg^2
(C) 6.75×10^{-11} N m^2/kg^2
(D) 3.75×10^{-9} N m^2 /kg^2

Q.25

As per the Essential Defence Services Act, 2021 new plan, how many ordnance factories that make ammunition and other equipment for the armed forces will become part of the seven government-owned corporate entities?

(A) 41
(B) 27
(C) 46
(D) 39

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**
Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.25 **(A)**			

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(C)**
Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(B)**
Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**
Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.25 **(B)**			

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (B) Ardour

'Ardour' is great enthusiasm or passion.

Q.2 · Answer (B) BCDA

B opens with Covid-19 changing every field, C names education as one of the worst hit, D adds the teachers who went unpaid, and A extends the misery to other professions too: BCDA.

Q.3 · Answer (C) are looking into

The phrasal verb is 'look into', to investigate; 'around' does not belong: 'are looking into the possibility'.

Q.4 · Answer (D) To study very hard

To 'hit the books' is to study hard.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Destroy

To 'devastate' is to destroy completely.

Q.6 · Answer (A) innocent

Children are thought of as 'innocent', and that is what the speakers wished they could have stayed.

Q.7 · Answer (D) I remember vivid

The verb 'remember' is modified by an adverb: 'I remember vividly'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) gone to

After 'did not' the verb takes its base form: 'did not go to Bombay yesterday'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Clean

'Squalid' means very dirty and unpleasant; its opposite is 'clean'.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Conceit

'Vanity' is excessive pride in oneself: 'conceit'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Our grandmother was preparing Diwali sweets.

'Were being prepared' is the past continuous passive, so the active is 'was preparing': 'Our grandmother was preparing Diwali sweets.'

Q.12 · Answer (C) will be

'In the future' calls for the future tense, and the singular 'game' takes a singular verb: 'will be famous'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) livelihood

The Act's stated aim is to enhance the 'livelihood security' of rural households, their means of earning a living, through guaranteed wage employment.

Q.14 · Answer (B) An easy task

'A piece of cake' is something very easy to do.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Declare

To 'profess' is to declare openly.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Queeuee

The correct spelling is 'queue'.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Children welcome summer vacation with zeal.

Only the last sentence spells 'vacation' correctly; the others have 'vecation', 'vacashun' and 'vakation'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) adverse

Vaccines were claimed to cause 'adverse', that is harmful, health conditions such as autism.

Q.22 · Answer (C) was

The belief is reported in the past ('Some people believed'), and 'autism' is singular: 'was'.

Q.23 · Answer (B) between
'Associations between autism and vaccines': 'between' links the two things associated.

Q.25 · Answer (A) themselves
The emphatic 'themselves' refers back to the plural 'vaccines': the vaccines themselves, as against the diseases.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (D) NFXHS
The last letter goes first and the first letter last, and the middle three move +1, +2, +3: POINT → T P K Q P and BONES → S P P H B. So SEVEN → N F X H S: NFXHS.

Q.2 · Answer (C) 3025
The terms are multiplied by 3, 7, 11 and increased by 5, 9 in turn: 11 × 3 = 33, + 5 = 38, × 7 = 266, + 9 = 275, × 11 = 3025.

Q.3 · Answer (B) WLLOY
The word is reversed and each letter replaced by its opposite in the alphabet (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y and so on): FLUTE → ETULF → VGFOU. So BLOOD → DOOLB → WLLOY.

Q.4 · Answer (B) –, =, ×, ×
115 – 25 = 15 × 2 × 3: both sides are 90.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Jeet
Siya > Pari > Kirti > Preeti > Deepika > Amita. Siya is not the highest, so Jeet is, and Jeet scored more than Pari.

Q.6 · Answer (A) 48
In each row the third number is the second times the square root of the first: 12 × √16 = 48 and 8 × √9 = 24. So 24 × √4 = 48.

Q.7 · Answer (C) 63
In each row the third number is the first plus four times the second plus 1: 14 + 16 + 1 = 31 and 38 + 40 + 1 = 79. So 30 + 32 + 1 = 63.

Q.8 · Answer (C) =, ×,+,÷,–,+
54 = 14 × 5 + 72 ÷ 18 – 31 + 11: the right side is 70 + 4 – 31 + 11 = 54.

Q.9 · Answer (A) (16, 8, 128)
The third number is the first times the difference of the first two: 15 × (15 – 5) = 150 and 7 × (7 – 5) = 14. Likewise 16 × (16 – 8) = 128.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Only conclusion I follows
All shoes are boots and all boots are heels, so all shoes are heels (I). The slippers that are shoes are boots, so II is false; and nothing says every shoe is a slipper (III).

Q.11 · Answer (A) 76
The terms are multiplied by 2, 4, 6 and reduced by 3, 5 in turn: 11 × 2 = 22, – 3 = 19, × 4 = 76, – 5 = 71, × 6 = 426.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 48 - 165
In the other pairs the second number is 10/3 of the first: 93 → 310, 54 → 180, 33 → 110. 48 × 10/3 = 160, not 165.

Q.15 · Answer (A) CBA
Each cluster is three consecutive letters in reverse, and the first letters W, R, M, H move back 5 each time. Next comes C: CBA.

Q.16 · Answer (D) JLHJMOFH

Each letter is replaced by the letters just before and after it: R → QS, I → HJ, S → RT, E → DF. So KING → JL HJ MO FH: JLHJMOFH.

Q.18 · Answer (B) LYZJ

The first letters move back 4 (X, T, P, L, H), the second back 3 (H, E, B, Y, V), the third back 2 (F, D, B, Z, X) and the fourth back 1 (M, L, K, J, I): LYZJ.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Friday

19 September 2000 is 366 days later (2000 was a leap year), 2 odd days on, so a Tuesday. From there to 19 January 2001 is 11 + 31 + 30 + 31 + 19 = 122 days, 17 weeks and 3 days: Friday.

Q.22 · Answer (C) –,+,÷,×,=

16 – 8 + 10 ÷ 2 × 4 = 28: 10 ÷ 2 × 4 = 20, and 16 – 8 + 20 = 28.

Q.24 · Answer (A) 4,2,1,5,3

Analogies before Analyze (o before y), then Ancestors, Android and Antibiotic (c, d, t after 'An'): 4, 2, 1, 5, 3.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 6 and 9

Swapping 6 and 9: $(2)^3 \div 4 + (72 \div 9) \times 6 - (21 \times 3) + (15 \times 7) = 2 + 48 - 63 + 105 = 92$.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.1 · Answer (D) ₹1,500

₹975 is 65% of the marked price: 975 ÷ 0.65 = ₹1,500.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 56

The third proportional to a and b is b^2/a: $28^2 \div 14 = 784 \div 14 = 56$.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 40% profit

MP = 70/42 = 5/3 of the CP, and SP = 21/25 of the MP = 21/25 × 5/3 = 7/5 of the CP. Profit = 2/5 = 40%.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 106 kg

The total rises by 8 × 2 = 16 kg, so the new man weighs 90 + 16 = 106 kg.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 27951

21,000 × 1.1 × 1.1 × 1.1 = 21,000 × 1.331 = 27,951.

Q.9 · Answer (B) 37.5 km/h

100 km at 30 km/h takes 10/3 hours, and the first 50 km at 25 km/h took 2 hours. The other 50 km must take 4/3 hours: 50 ÷ 4/3 = 37.5 km/h.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 3,06,045

A number divisible by 15 must end in 0 or 5 and have a digit sum divisible by 3. 3 + 0 + 6 + 0 + 4 + 5 = 18; the others' digit sums are 29, 25 and 26.

Q.11 · Answer (D) 3 cm, 5 cm and 1 cm

Any two sides of a triangle must add up to more than the third, but 3 + 1 = 4 is less than 5.

Q.17 · Answer (A) 768 cm^3

SSC's key reads 'twice more than its breadth' as the breadth plus twice it: 8 + 16 = 24 cm (a length of twice the breadth, 16 cm, gives 512 cm^3, which is not an option). The height is 8 ÷ 2 = 4 cm, so the volume is 24 × 8 × 4 = 768 cm^3.

Q.19 · Answer (D) ₹7,000

Cash: 40% of the marked price less 24% = 0.4 × 0.76 = 0.304 of it; card: 60% plus 1.5% = 0.6 × 1.015 = 0.609. So 0.913 × MP = ₹6,391 and MP = ₹7,000.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 240 seconds

27 km/h = 7.5 m/s and 45 km/h = 12.5 m/s. Running the same way, Badal gains 5 m/s and meets Ali again when he has gained a full lap: 1200 ÷ 5 = 240 seconds.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 154410
After rent 85% is left, and 40% of that is saved: 0.85 × 0.4 = 0.34 of the income. 52,500 ÷ 0.34 = 1,54,411.76, or ₹1,54,410 to the nearest ten.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 1152 m^3
16 × 12 × 6 = 1,152 m^3.

Q.23 · Answer (C) 36 cm^2
The third side is 36 – 17 – 9 = 10 cm and s = 18. By Heron's formula, area = √(18 × 1 × 9 × 8) = √1,296 = 36 cm^2.

Q.25 · Answer (B) ₹8,000
Madhuri saves 20% and Sushma 5% of her salary. 0.2M = 0.05S, so S = 4M; with M + S = ₹10,000, M = ₹2,000 and S = ₹8,000.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Ghatam
T. H. 'Vikku' Vinayakram is the best-known exponent of the ghatam, the clay-pot percussion instrument of Carnatic music.

Q.2 · Answer (B) My Life, My Music
SSC's key gives 'My Life, My Music', the option nearest to Ravi Shankar's 1968 book 'My Music, My Life'; the option prints the two halves of the title the other way round. His later autobiography is 'Raga Mala'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) elected by the members of the Legislative Council
Under Article 182 the Legislative Council chooses two of its own members as its Chairman and Deputy Chairman.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Nadhaswaram
Sheik Chinna Moulana (1924-1999) was a celebrated nadaswaram player of Carnatic music.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Sangeet Natak Akademi
The Sangeet Natak Akademi gives the Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puraskar to young artists in the performing arts.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Emotional
Organisms adapt through their structure (morphological), body functions (physiological) and behaviour; 'emotional' is not a type of adaptation.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Winds of Samsara
Ricky Kej won the Grammy for Best New Age Album at the 57th awards (2015) for 'Winds of Samsara', made with Wouter Kellerman. 'Divine Tides' won him a later Grammy.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Dobereiner’s Law of Triads
SSC's key gives Döbereiner's law of triads: in 1817 Johann Döbereiner noticed that strontium's atomic weight is about the mean of calcium's and barium's, the first of his triads of similar elements. (The question's example does not hold: phosphorus, 31, is not the mean of nitrogen, 14, and arsenic, 75.)

Q.10 · Answer (D) United States of America
The United States won the most gold medals at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics, 39, one more than China.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Hans Christian Oersted
In 1820 Hans Christian Oersted saw a compass needle deflected by a current in a nearby wire, the first evidence that electricity and magnetism are linked.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Tabla
Pandit Anokhelal Mishra was a tabla player of the Banaras gharana.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Barakar
The Barakar, on which the Maithon dam stands, is the Damodar's main tributary.

Q.14 · Answer (B) Anshu Malik
Anshu Malik took silver in the women's 57 kg at the World Championships in Oslo in October 2021, the first Indian woman wrestler to reach a world final.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Bharatanatyam
Shanta and V. P. Dhananjayan are a Bharatanatyam dancing couple from Chennai, founders of the Bharatakalaanjali school.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Sa-Dhan
The Reserve Bank recognises Sa-Dhan, an association of microfinance institutions, as a self-regulatory organisation for the sector.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 2021
Matha B. Manjamma Jogati, a transgender Jogati Nritya dancer from Karnataka, was awarded the Padma Shri for art in 2021.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Nalanda Dance Research Centre
The Nalanda Bharata Muni Samman is given by Mumbai's Nalanda Dance Research Centre at its annual Nalanda Nrityotsava.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Basketball
A free throw is an unopposed shot from the free-throw line in basketball, awarded after a foul.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Rectilinear motion
Motion along a straight line is rectilinear: an object lifted straight up and down, soldiers marching in a parade and a freely falling body all move in straight lines.

Q.21 · Answer (B) BV Acharya
'All From Memory' is the autobiography of B. V. Acharya, the senior Karnataka lawyer and former Advocate General of the state.

Q.22 · Answer (C) West Bengal
West Bengal's 'Paray Shikshalaya' (neighbourhood school) began in February 2022, with open-air classes near their homes for pupils of classes 1 to 7 after the Covid-19 closures.

Q.23 · Answer (D) Jugal Hansraj
Actor Jugal Hansraj wrote 'The Coward and the Sword', a children's fantasy novel published in 2021.

Q.24 · Answer (C) 6.75×10^{-11} N m²/kg²
Cavendish's torsion balance gave the Earth's density, from which G works out at about 6.74×10^{-11} N m²/kg², within about 1% of today's 6.674×10^{-11}. SSC's key gives 6.75×10^{-11}, the only option of the right order of magnitude.

Q.25 · Answer (A) 41
In October 2021 the Ordnance Factory Board was dissolved and its 41 factories were divided among seven new government-owned companies.

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